National
Qualifications
2025

X849/76/11

Modern Studies
Paper 1

FRIDAY, 23 MAY
9:00 AM – 10:45 AM

Total marks — 52

SECTION 1 — DEMOCRACY IN SCOTLAND AND THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 1(a) **OR** 1(b) **OR** 1(c).

SECTION 2 — SOCIAL ISSUES IN THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Part A Social inequality

Part B Crime and the law

Attempt **ONE** question from 2(a) **OR** 2(b) **OR** 2(c) **OR** 2(d).

SECTION 3 — INTERNATIONAL ISSUES — 12 marks

Part C World powers

Part D World issues

Attempt **ONE** question from 3(a) **OR** 3(b) **OR** 3(c) **OR** 3(d).

Write your answers clearly in the answer booklet provided. In the answer booklet you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

Before leaving the examination room you must give your answer booklet to the Invigilator; if you do not, you may lose all the marks for this paper.

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MARKS

SECTION 1 — DEMOCRACY IN SCOTLAND AND THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 1(a) **OR** 1(b) **OR** 1(c)

Question 1

(a) To what extent do views differ about the most effective way to govern Scotland?
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

OR

(b) To what extent can it be successfully argued that Brexit has not been beneficial to the UK?
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

OR

(c) To what extent can UK voting behaviour be fully explained by the **age** of voters?
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

[Now go to SECTION 2 on *page 03*]

MARKS

SECTION 2 — SOCIAL ISSUES IN THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 2(a) **OR** 2(b) **OR** 2(c) **OR** 2(d)

Question 2

Part A: Social inequality

Answers may refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both.

(a) Some factors are more important than others in causing health inequalities.
Discuss. **20**

OR

(b) Government measures have failed to reduce inequalities.
Discuss. **20**

OR

Part B: Crime and the law

Answers may refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both.

(c) Criminals are not born, they are created by the society in which they live.
Discuss. **20**

OR

(d) The most significant impact of crime on wider society is economic rather than social.
Discuss. **20**

[Now go to SECTION 3 on *page 04*]

MARKS

SECTION 3 — INTERNATIONAL ISSUES — 12 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 3(a) **OR** 3(b) **OR** 3(c) **OR** 3(d)

Question 3

Part C: World powers

With reference to a world power you have studied

(a) analyse the ability of one branch of government or political institution to dominate government decision-making. **12**

OR

(b) evaluate the government's success in responding to socio-economic inequalities. **12**

OR

Part D: World issues

With reference to a world issue you have studied

(c) analyse the effects of the issue on the wider international community. **12**

OR

(d) evaluate the success of individual countries in responding to the issue. **12**

[END OF QUESTION PAPER]